PIONEER · EDITION 005

The Double Portion Mandate

Vision 2040 | Shift the Paradigm. Double the Territory.

October 2026 · Featuring Rev. Alex Asirifi

Pioneering is not about maintaining what was. When the mantle falls, we don’t simply preserve the legacy — we extend it, multiply it, and take the territory further. The National Director of Rhema Ghana tells the story behind a difficult beginning, and Elisha shows what it costs to carry an assignment forward.

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The Road Less Travelled

Building Rhema Ghana: Faith, Patience and the Work of Pioneering

Rev. Alex Asirifi — National Director, Rhema Ghana

> Pioneering is often told as a story of vision, faith and bold beginnings. But what happens when the journey does not go as planned? What do you do when the doors you expected to open remain closed, when resources are limited, and when you have to rebuild your approach?

In this conversation with PIONEER, Rev. Alex Asirifi, National Director of Rhema Ghana, shares the story behind the establishment of Rhema in Ghana, the lessons he has learned through difficult beginnings, and why building the right team, planning carefully and embracing mentorship are essential to sustainable expansion.

Take us back to the beginning. How did your journey with Rhema begin, and how did you eventually become the National Director of Rhema Ghana?

My journey started in Ghana. I had a pastor who would play Kenneth Hagin's tapes throughout the night, and we would go and listen. I began reading Brother Hagin's books, and when I had the opportunity to travel to the United States in 2003, I had it in my heart to attend his Bible school.

At first, I thought I wanted to become a certified public accountant, but when I started college, I realised my heart was not there. I eventually went to Rhema Bible Training College. While I was there, the Lord began dealing with my heart about returning to Ghana.

I completed my training in 2007, and that same year, I married Denise, my wife, who also had a heart for serving outside the United States. Together, we decided to establish a Bible school in Ghana. It was not officially Rhema at the time, but our intention was for it to become a Rhema campus one day.

Our beginning was not straightforward. We started a Bible school, initially called Global Harvest Bible Training College, and later used the name Rhema Accra without having completed the necessary formal approval process. We were instructed to stop using the Rhema name and take down our signage. We had to acknowledge that things had not been done properly and wait for the process to be resolved.

It took about a year and a half before we were invited to Zambia for further training and assessment. Rhema Nigeria also became involved in helping us through the process. Eventually, in 2017, we

officially became Rhema Accra Campus, initially operating under coordinators. Over time, the work developed, and we were eventually recognised as the leadership of Rhema Ghana.

Today, we have three campuses. It has been a journey of patience, correction and growth.

What were some of the biggest challenges you faced when you first moved to Ghana to establish the work?

One of the first challenges was acceptance. I was returning to Ghana with my African-American wife, and people wanted to know what we could offer them. We could explain the message we carried, but people also had to understand and accept us.

Accommodation was another challenge. We stayed with someone for nine months with our two young children before we could get our own place. Finding a suitable facility for the Bible school was also difficult. We had initially been offered a place, but that arrangement did not work out, so when we returned to Ghana in 2013, we had to find somewhere else to begin.

We also struggled to find the right instructors. We initially brought in people who appreciated Brother Hagin's message but were not Rhema-trained. Some of those arrangements did not work out, and we had to retrain people and rethink our approach.

At one point, I was teaching several subjects across the terms, while my wife also helped with classes and administration. It was demanding, especially with two young children.

Looking back, I can see that we made mistakes. But those experiences taught us lessons that we can now share with others who want to pioneer a Bible school.

How has the vision for Rhema Ghana evolved, and what has been your approach to expansion?

Our vision is to equip believers and ministers so that they can, in turn, equip others. Ghana now has 16 regions, and one of our targets has been to establish a campus in every region.

However, expansion cannot happen through one or two people alone. You need a team, and you need people who can teach and develop others. Because of this, we have spent considerable time raising leaders and training instructors.

We currently have three campuses: Accra, Tema and Ejisu. The Tema and Ejisu campuses operate on weekends, with coordinators supported by teams and instructors from the headquarters.

For Ejisu, Pastor Charles Boakye, who had previously attended Rhema in the United States, made facilities available for the campus. We built a team around him and provided administrative support so that he would not have to carry everything himself.

We took a similar approach with Tema. We trained the people who would coordinate these campuses before launching them. A lot of prayer and thought went into selecting those individuals.

For me, expansion is not simply about opening more locations. It is about ensuring that we have the right people who understand the vision and can sustain the work.

What has developing leaders and building teams taught you about sustaining a vision?

It has helped us tremendously. We started wrongly in some respects, but we have learned how important it is to identify the right people, train them and build a structure around them.

Today, I can be in the United States and the work in Ghana can continue. That is possible because we have invested in developing people. My wife and I have worked to establish a process of ongoing training, and we are still developing it.

We look for people with the right heart, people who understand the vision and are willing to commit to the work for the long term.

Our approach to developing instructors has also become more structured. We observe people, identify potential, interview them and take them through training. They study a training manual, enter a leadership development process, observe classes and gradually begin teaching under supervision. We give them feedback as they grow into the role.

Developing leaders is not a one-time activity. You have to keep the vision before people, continue training them and help them grow. That is how you build a team that can do more together than one person could accomplish alone.

Looking back, what would you advise someone who is preparing to pioneer a Rhema campus?

First, do not rush. Be prayerful and take time to observe people properly. Do not hurry to give people titles or positions before you have established the work and understood their strengths.

Build a team gradually. You may need one, two or even three years to identify the right people, pray with them, train them and help them understand the vision before opening a campus.

You should also have a suitable facility and a clear understanding of the people you intend to reach. Who is your target audience? How many students can you realistically expect? What will the fees be, and will the income be sufficient to cover the campus's operating costs?

You need to do your homework. Faith is essential, but you must also think through the practical realities of running a school.

I would encourage anyone preparing to pioneer to consider the people, the facility, the finances and the audience before launching. Do not make the mistake of rushing into something simply because you are excited about the vision.

How important have relationships, partnerships and mentorship been to the development of Rhema Ghana?

They have been very important. I see Rhema as a family, and I believe we should be willing to share our vision with one another, receive guidance and learn from other leaders.

Partnership is not just about money. There is a book called Friendraising, and I believe in building healthy relationships. People do not automatically partner with you simply because you belong to the same organisation. Trust takes time to develop.

Rhema Nigeria played a significant role in our journey after we became a Rhema campus in 2017. There was practical support, including help towards purchasing a vehicle, and leaders also travelled to teach and support us. Those contributions made a difference in establishing the work.

We have also benefited from mentorship. People have helped us, guided us and encouraged us through different stages of the journey. I am grateful for that.

Pioneers should understand that they do not have to build alone. But they must be willing to develop relationships, receive counsel and remain teachable.

What have you learned about financial sustainability, and why should pioneers pay attention to the numbers?

This is an area I believe every pioneer must take seriously. We still experience financial challenges in Ghana, and one of the things we have had to confront is the relationship between student numbers and operating costs.

Whether you have many students or few, the rent still has to be paid. Electricity and other expenses do not disappear because enrolment is low.

That is why I believe you must plan carefully before starting a campus. You need to have a realistic idea of the number of students you can reach and whether the income from those students can sustain the operation.

You must believe in the value of what you are offering and communicate that value to people. We cannot continually make excuses about low numbers and expect the work to flourish.

There may be situations where a larger campus can strategically support a smaller one, but that must be an intentional decision. Otherwise, a campus without a sustainable financial plan will struggle.

We must not use emotion alone to make decisions about expansion. We need faith, but we also need sound planning, accountability and an honest assessment of what it will take to sustain the work.

Was there ever a time you considered giving up or returning to the United States? What kept you going?

Yes. There was a time when Rhema was silent, and we were dealing with the difficulties of establishing the work. I reached a point where I thought about leaving Ghana and returning to the United States.

We had moved from the United States with our children to establish a Bible school, and there were times when we did not know what would happen next. It was difficult to wait for answers and not know how things would work out.

What kept me going was the mandate in my heart.

When I attended Rhema, I encountered a message of faith that I believed people in Ghana needed to hear. I knew that I could return to the United States and pursue other opportunities, but I remained convinced that this message was needed in Ghana.

That conviction kept me moving forward. I realised that the assignment had to be something settled in my heart, not merely an idea in my head.

Vision 2040 aims to expand Rhema's reach across Nigeria and West Africa. From your experience, what should be prioritised to make that expansion sustainable?

For me, the number one priority is training quality leaders and quality instructors. You can have a vision to establish campuses in many places, but if you do not have the right people to teach, lead and sustain the work, expansion becomes difficult.

You need a strong team. You need people who understand the vision and can carry it forward.

That is why we have invested so much time in developing leaders in Ghana. We are still growing, and there is more to do, but we have seen the value of taking time to train people and build a structure around them.

As we look towards expansion across West Africa, I believe we must give serious attention to the people who will carry the work. We must prepare them before we place responsibility on them.

Finally, what would you say to someone who believes God is calling them to pioneer but feels uncertain or unqualified?

If there is genuine doubt about whether God has called you to do something, I believe you should wait until you have clarity. You need to be settled in your heart before beginning a pioneering assignment.

But there is a difference between doubting the call and feeling unqualified or afraid. If you believe God has called you but you are struggling with fear, you may need encouragement from other people.

Mentorship is important. Submit yourself to people who can guide you, encourage you and help you prepare for the work. Rhema Nigeria played that role in our journey, and I am grateful for the leaders who invested in us.

My advice is to seek clarity, be willing to learn, and allow others to help you grow. You do not have to know everything at the beginning, but you must be prepared to learn and be developed.

Pioneering is not just about receiving a vision. It is about preparing yourself and others to carry that vision well.

EDITOR'S NOTE

Sustainable expansion is built, not declared

Rev. Alex Asirifi's journey reminds us that pioneering is not always a straightforward path from vision to achievement. Sometimes it involves mistakes, delays, difficult decisions and the willingness to change course. His experience offers an important lesson for Vision 2040: sustainable expansion requires more than opening new campuses. It requires prepared leaders, capable instructors, healthy partnerships, sound financial planning and systems that allow the work to continue beyond its founders.

> *It has been a journey of patience, correction and growth.*

> *The assignment had to be something settled in my heart, not merely an idea in my head.*

COUNTRY FOCUS

The Republic of Niger

To win a nation, you must first know its story.

POPULATION SIZE

~28.8 Million (2026 est.)

A vast, resilient nation positioned at the heart of the Sahel. Despite severe economic and environmental challenges, the people have a strong communal bond and an enduring endurance that makes them faithful stewards once they are grounded in the Word.

DOMINANT RELIGION

Islam (99%)

Like Senegal, Niger is a land of deep religious tradition and intense Islamic practice.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Small Minority (~0.3%–1%, Catholic & Protestant/Evangelical)

The Christian population is tiny, resilient, and mostly concentrated in Niamey and southern urban pockets such as Maradi and Zinder. The primary need is moving believers from isolation and survival into faith-filled impact through practical leadership training.

LITERACY RATE

35% – 38%

French is used for official administration, but oral tradition drives deep heart connection. Teaching must rely heavily on the spoken word, dynamic oral storytelling, and translation into regional trade languages.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

French (Official), Hausa & Zarma/Songhai

Hausa is spoken by over 50% of the population, especially along the southern border with Nigeria. A pioneer fluent in Hausa instantly unlocks half the nation, while French serves the educated and administrative sectors in Niamey.

YOUTH POPULATION

70% (Under 25)

Niger has one of the youngest populations in the world, with a median age of about 15.7. Millions of energetic youth are searching for hope, global standards, vocational skills, and dynamic leadership.

URBAN VS RURAL

Highly Rural (~81% Rural)

While Niamey is the diplomatic and administrative hub, the vast majority of the population is spread across agrarian and pastoral communities in Maradi, Zinder, and Tahoua. Satellite and mobile training hubs are essential.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Extremely Scarce / Denominational

Formal, non-denominational Bible training with practical ministry application is almost non-existent. A pioneer campus in Niamey would serve as a vital training oasis for the entire country and the surrounding Sahel regions.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Agadez Cross

Niger is home to the famous Agadez Cross, a centuries-old symbol of guidance and protection worn by the Tuareg nomads navigating the vast Sahara Desert.

STATE FOCUS

Ekiti State

Fountain of Knowledge.

GEOPOLITICAL ZONE

South-West

Ekiti sits within Nigeria's South-West, sharing the Yoruba cultural heartland while holding a distinct identity built on scholarship and honour.

POPULATION SIZE

3.8 Million

Highly homogeneous, culturally refined, and intensely value-driven. While Ado-Ekiti is the commercial and educational centre, Ekiti's true strength is distributed across its 16 Local Government Areas, where community honour and academic reputation run deep.

DOMINANT RELIGIONS

Christianity (Predominant) & Islam (Minority)

Christianity is widely embraced, but religious routine can often replace spiritual vitality. The gist here is moving a highly intellectual and traditional church culture from intellectual agreement into active, faith-filled demonstration.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Anglican, Catholic, Christ Apostolic Church (CAC) & Fast-Growing Pentecostal

Rich historic Christian roots, especially as a cradle for major revivalist movements like CAC. The key need is structured, practical ministry training that honours historic revival legacies while equipping modern leaders for contemporary societal impact.

LITERACY RATE

75% – 80% (Among the highest in Nigeria)

Known as the Fountain of Knowledge, with a massive concentration of professors and academics. Teaching must be intellectually sound, well-structured, and precise — shallow delivery will not command respect here.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

English & Yoruba (with distinct local dialects like Ekiti & Yagba)

English is widely used across all sectors due to high literacy, but local Yoruba dialects carry deep communal warmth. A pioneer who speaks with clarity and respects local cultural etiquette wins long-term credibility fast.

YOUTH POPULATION

60%

An ambitious youth cohort concentrated in university towns like Ado-Ekiti and Ikole-Ekiti. They are eager for global standards, practical leadership training, and career-aligned ministry development to excel in a competitive environment.

URBAN VS RURAL

Semi-Urban & Agrarian Network

Major population clusters surround educational and commercial hubs, but agrarian towns drive the local economy. A dual strategy using an urban core campus in Ado-Ekiti paired with mobile modules across key towns like Ikere, Ijero, and Oye yields maximum reach.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Traditional Denominational Seminaries / Scarce Practical Faith Institutes

Plenty of formal theological colleges exist, but practical how-to faith and leadership training is rare. We offer a vibrant training oasis that bridges deep biblical doctrine with real-world application.

PIONEER PRO-TIP

The “Fountain of Knowledge” Approach

Ekiti respects intellectual integrity and moral character above loud claims. In a state that prides itself on academic excellence, we lead with well-reasoned truth, impeccable structure, and genuine humility. We aren’t just bringing lectures; we are training thinkers to become doers who transform their communities through the power of the Word.

THE BIBLICAL ‘OG’

Elisha: The Pioneer of Continuity & Expansion

The man who carried the assignment forward.

> Elisha represents the ultimate blueprint for seamless transition and generational scale. He didn’t start with a brand-new assignment. He stepped into an assignment that someone else had already begun.

> *And Elisha took the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and struck the waters… and they parted.*
>
> 2 KINGS 2:14

He followed Elijah. He served him. He watched him. He learned from him.

And when the time came, Elisha didn't simply say, "I want what Elijah had." He was asking for the grace to carry the work forward.

The Continuity & Expansion Model

ELIJAH

The Trailblazers

Breaks the hard ground · Confronts the territorial altars · Ignites the spark

ELISHA

The System Builders

Builds the permanent structure · Establishes the regional hubs · Manages the generational fire

The Three Laws of Succession

- Unshakeable Alignment: Elisha refused to leave Elijah's side from Gilgal to Jordan. You cannot carry the mantle of a vision you abandon halfway.
- Honour the Blueprint: His first act was using Elijah's same mantle at the same river. He proved the inherited foundation still works when executed with faith.
- Institutional Scale: Elisha moved out of the caves and built organised campuses — the Sons of the Prophets — embedding the Word directly into the nation's fabric.

MYTH VS FACT

Succession is not copying

Myth: Succession means copying blindly without growing. Fact: Elisha kept the core DNA — the mantle — while doubling the operational output.

PIONEER PRO-TIP

The Mantle Principle

Never discard the mantle of those before you just to prove independence. Pick up the mantle, strike the water, and build the second story.

> *Never discard the mantle of those before you just to prove independence.*

> *Elisha kept the core DNA while doubling the operational output.*

YOUR NEXT STEP

Find Your Place in the Vision

Vision 2040 is not a project for a few people — it is a mission for all of us.

> Whether God is calling you to pioneer, support those on the field, or help prepare the way for future campuses, there is a place for you in this vision. Here are three practical ways to get involved today.

01 · JOIN THE VISION

Expression of Interest

If you wish to volunteer, serve on an expansion team, support our ongoing initiatives, or explore contribution opportunities for Vision 2040, we welcome your outreach. Complete the Expression of Interest form and tell us where you would like to serve.

02 · SHARE A CONTACT OR RECOMMEND A LOCATION

Contact & City Recommendation

Do you know of a city, town, community, church, or ministry that could host a future Rhema campus? Your recommendation could play a vital role in our expansion efforts. Submit a campus recommendation and help us map the frontier.

03 · PREPARE TO PIONEER

Pioneer Development Programme

Not everyone is called to pioneer a Rhema campus. Some are called to plant churches, launch ministries, begin outreaches, or take the Gospel into places where Christ is not yet known. If you sense that God is calling you to pioneer something, we'd love to walk that journey with you through training, mentorship, and practical equipping. Register for the Pioneer Development Programme.

Every great work begins with a single step — take yours today.